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## Education

**Ph.D. in Economics** [*expected*], Toulouse School of Economics 2022-2027
*Visiting Scholar*, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia (US) Spring 2025
**MRes. in Economics**, Toulouse School of Economics 2021-2022
**M.Sc. in Economic Theory and Econometrics**, Toulouse School of Economics 2020-2021
**M.Sc. in Economics**, Toulouse School of Economics 2019-2020
**B.Sc. in Economics**, Universitat Pompeu Fabra, Barcelona (Spain) 2013-2017
*Visiting Student*, Aalto-yliopisto, Helsinki (Finland) 2015

## References

**Prof. Matteo Bobba**
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**Prof. Olivier De Groote**
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**Dr. Ana Gazmuri**
Universidad Diego Portales
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**Dr. François Poinas**
Toulouse School of Economics
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## Research interests

**Primary field:** Labor Economics.
**Secondary fields:** Education Economics, Applied Microeconomics.

## Teaching experience

### *Teaching Assistant Coordinator*

**Toulouse School of Economics**
Program Evaluation, graduate 2024-2025

### *Teaching Assistant*

**Toulouse School of Economics**
Program Evaluation, graduate 2022-2025
Applied Econometrics, graduate 2023-2024

**Université Toulouse 1 Capitole**
Microeconomics I 2022-2023
Macroeconomics II 2021-2023

## Relevant positions

**Research Stay** at the Ministry of Education, Santiago (Chile) Fall 2024
On-site access to administrative microdata for doctoral research.
**Consultant** at The World Bank 2021-2023
**Research Assistant** to Pepita Miquel-Florensa, Toulouse School of Economics 2020
**Data Analyst** at FocusEconomics, Barcelona (Spain) 2017-2019

## Fellowships and Awards

Mobility grant, Toulouse School of Economics 2025
Doctoral contract, Université Toulouse 1 Capitole 2022-2025
MRes Funded Position, Toulouse School of Economics 2021-2022
M2 ETE Funded Position, Toulouse School of Economics 2020-2021

## Job Market Paper

**Funding Instruments and Effort Choices in Higher Education**, with Juan Pal

This paper examines the effects of tuition-free higher education (TF) policies on student enrollment and academic performance, focusing on the 2016 Chilean reform that eliminated higher education tuition fees for students from the lowest five income deciles. Using a difference-in-differences approach, we find that TF increased enrollment among eligible students by around 4 percentage points—concentrated among lower-ability students—and both reduced dropout rates and increased graduation rates among students enrolled before the reform. For post-reform cohorts, these effects diminish: graduation and on-time graduation gains persist but are smaller, and the dropout reduction vanishes. To disentangle the role of student effort from composition effects, we develop a dynamic structural model in which students choose effort levels in response to financial incentives. The model reproduces the enrollment response estimated by difference-in-differences and its concentration among lower-ability students. Counterfactual simulations show that reintroducing annual progress requirements reduces the cost per additional graduate from $108,000 to $70,000, but widens socioeconomic gaps in graduation. Minimum entry scores would raise the cost per additional graduate nearly threefold and leave the socioeconomic gap almost unchanged. Phasing out the benefit for middle-income students and providing a stipend to the poorest raises graduation as much as TF does, at lower cost and with a smaller socioeconomic gap.

## Working paper

**Differences in returns to vocational and general education: evidence from a differentiated schooling system**, with François Poinas

The literature on returns to education has focused on years of schooling and fields of study, and less on whether post-secondary education is vocational or academic. We study how this choice affects occupations and wages in Germany. We estimate a dynamic semi-structural model of completed post-secondary education and first occupation choice, using the German Socio-Economic Panel. Occupations are described by their cognitive, interpersonal and manual task content, and selection runs through latent cognitive and non-cognitive abilities. Cognitive ability strongly predicts post-secondary attainment, especially university, while non-cognitive ability plays no role once cognitive ability is accounted for. Conditional on abilities and occupational tasks, an apprenticeship raises first-job hourly wages by 11% relative to basic education, and a university degree by 45%. Vocational degrees move workers towards manual and cognitive occupations and away from interpersonal ones. This occupational sorting explains only a modest part of the wage returns to education (8 to 20%), and almost none of the gap between university and apprenticeship graduates, which arises within occupations.

## Work in progress

**Co-Residence, Housing and Labor Market Decisions**

**General Equilibrium Effects of Large-Scale Education Expansions**, with Matteo Bobba, Olivier De Groote, Ana Gazmuri and Juan Pal

While small-scale educational interventions provide valuable insights into effective investments, large-scale education programs may generate substantial general equilibrium (GE) effects that alter their ultimate impact on welfare and inequality. This paper studies the expansion of higher education in Chile over the last two decades. Deregulation, the introduction of state-guaranteed student loans, and the scaling up of government scholarships nearly tripled the number of seats in higher education. Over the same period, the college wage premium fell by 10–15 percent. We first provide reduced-form evidence on the local labor market effects of the expansion using a shift-share design. We instrument regional graduate employment with national growth in graduate employment across industries, weighted by each region's baseline industry composition of graduate employment. We find that inflows of college graduates lower graduates' wages relative to those of non-graduates: an additional 10,000 graduate workers in a region reduces their mean monthly wage by about 0.3 percent, with no significant effect on the wages of non-graduates. Motivated by this evidence, we develop a dynamic GE model of education and labor market choices. Students choose a program from personalized choice sets determined by the centralized admission system, and then either graduate from that program, switch and graduate from a different one, or drop out. Upon entering the labor market, workers choose an occupation and a region, where skill prices clear competitive labor markets and comparative advantage depends on both worker type and field of study. We estimate the model on linked administrative records that follow students from their application rankings through their labor market histories. The model allows us to decompose observed wage changes into individual returns to education and GE effects, and to evaluate counterfactual policies, such as expanding seats in rural regions and affirmative action for underrepresented groups, separating their welfare effects into direct access gains and indirect wage effects.

## Policy work

**Background Note on Bringing Climate Change into Vulnerability Analysis**, with Sandra Baquie. The World Bank, 2023.

## Professional activities

**Service:** European Network for Training in Economic Research (ENTER) network coordinator. 2023-2026

## Seminars and conferences

41st meeting of the European Economic Association, 38th European Association of Labour Economists Conference, Maastricht University (expected), University College London (expected). 2026

Penn Empirical Micro Lunch, ENTER Jamboree, TSE Economics of Education Workshop, 40th meeting of the European Economic Association, Mannheim University, European Winter Meeting of the Econometric Society, Dynamic Structural Econometrics Conference of the Econometric Society, 50th Symposium of the Spanish Economic Association. 2025

TSE Economics of Education Workshop. 2024

## Other information

**Software** R, Stata, Python, SQL.
**Languages** English (fluent), Catalan (native), French (native), Spanish (native), German (beginner).